Whatever his reasons, Gorbachev had the intelligence to admit Communism was not working, the courage to battle for change, and, ultimately, the wisdom to introduce the beginnings of democracy, individual freedom, and free enterprise.

As I said at the Brandenburg Gate in 1987, the Soviet Union faced a choice: Either it made fundamental changes or it became obsolete.

Gorbachev saw the handwriting on the Wall and opted for change.

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During our first session at the Moscow summit, he and I pledged again to do our best during my last months in office to complete the START treaty and parallel agreements to reduce chemical weapons and conventional forces in Europe, although I emphasized that no agreement on long-range missiles was possible until the Soviets dismantled the huge radar installation they were building at Krasnoyarsk in violation of the ABM treaty. Despite our differences, it was not a contentious meeting. Even though I raised my pet concerns about human rights and religious freedom, Gorbachev didn't bristle as he had in the past. "It was a good session and a nice way to launch the summit," I wrote that evening in my diary.

After my session with Gorbachev, Nancy and I wanted to go out on the streets of Moscow and meet some Muscovites. Our son Ron had told us about Arabat Street, which was lined with shops and artists displaying their work. "It was amazing how quickly the street was jammed curb to curb with people—warm, friendly people who couldn't have been more affectionate," I wrote later in my diary. "In addition to our Secret Service, the KGB was on hand, and I've never seen such brutal manhandling as they did on their own people who were in no way getting out of hand." Boy, what